

Marketing Audit Report

<https://retailcalculus.com>

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Overall Marketing Score: 22/100 (Grade: F)

Retail Calculus has a legitimately differentiated product — a bolt-on SaaS suite for furniture and big-ticket retailers co-founded by a former Crate & Barrel Chief Transformation Officer — but the website is a 2016-era single-page brochure with 520 words, no CTAs, no customer proof, no pricing, and zero analytics. The site generates near-zero organic traffic and near-zero inbound leads; the only working conversion path is a bare contact form buried at the bottom of the page. Implementing the quick-win fixes alone (hero CTA, meta tags, GA4, copyright update) costs less than a day of effort and can move the score above 45 within 30 days. The single biggest opportunity: making the Crate & Barrel founder story the hero headline — a differentiator no competitor can match.

Score Breakdown



Category	Score	Weight	Status
Content & Messaging	22/100	25%	Critical
Conversion Optimization	18/100	20%	Critical
SEO & Discoverability	19/100	20%	Critical
Competitive Positioning	28/100	15%	Critical
Brand & Trust	28/100	10%	Critical
Growth & Strategy	18/100	10%	Critical

Key Findings

Severity	Finding
Critical	Zero CTAs above the fold — the hero section is a rotating image carousel with no button, no demo link, and no conversion path. The only actionable element on the page is a Name / Email / Submit form buried at the very bottom.
Critical	Demo link is commented out in the HTML and pointed to a raw IP address. The highest-intent action a B2B prospect can take has been deliberately disabled with no replacement.
Critical	No analytics installed — zero GA4, no GTM, no pixel, no heatmaps. The team has no data on who visits, where traffic comes from, or whether anyone reaches the contact form. Optimization is impossible without measurement.
Critical	Meta description is empty and title tag is only 'Retail Calculus' (15 chars, no keywords). Google auto-generates a disjointed snippet from body copy, destroying click-through rates from any organic search.
Critical	Single-page application with ~520 total words and no sitemap.xml or robots.txt. Zero sub-pages, zero blog, zero product pages — SEO ranking potential is near zero for any competitive keyword.
High	No customer proof anywhere: zero named client testimonials, zero case studies, zero logos, zero outcome metrics. The only testimonials are generic quotes from Mitch Kapor, Andy Clarke, and Howard Gardner — none relevant to retail software.
High	No pricing page, no pricing tier framing, no contact-for-pricing CTA with context. Every buyer must enter a blind sales conversation with zero cost anchoring. Competitors Celerant (\$199-\$399/mo) and Lightspeed (\$89/mo) publish pricing openly.
High	Zero presence on G2, Capterra, Trustpilot, or Software Advice. Furniture Wizard has 678 Trustpilot reviews; STORIS has a named customer community. Retail Calculus is invisible on every platform where B2B software buyers research vendors.
High	Copyright footer reads 2016 — 10 years out of date — signaling to buyers and crawlers that the site has been abandoned. This critically undermines a company positioning itself as a digital modernization vendor.
High	No schema markup of any type (Organization, SoftwareApplication, LocalBusiness, Person). Rich SERP features, Knowledge Panel eligibility, and AI citability all require structured data that is completely absent.

Medium	All 10 images have empty alt attributes. Three hero images are served as 3x retina JPGs with no WebP, no srcset, and no lazy loading. Ten render-blocking CSS files delay First Contentful Paint for every visitor.
Medium	Product descriptions are feature-centric not outcome-centric. 'Optimus — An omni-channel inventory availability platform that performs real-time rules based and manual customer order inventory reservation' has no pain framing or ROI language.
Medium	Strongest credibility asset — co-founder Edward Rennemann, former Chief Transformation Officer at Crate & Barrel — is buried below 'Incorporated in 2016' in the About section. It should be the first thing every visitor reads.
Low	Raw IP address exposed in HTML comments. Even though commented out, it is visible in View Source and represents an exposed infrastructure endpoint that should be removed immediately.
Low	No privacy policy or terms of service pages — a legal liability for GDPR/CCPA compliance and a trust gap for enterprise buyers who require legal review before vendor engagement.

Prioritized Action Plan

Quick Wins (This Week)

1. Add a 'Book a Demo' CTA button to the hero section above the fold — the single highest-impact change, requires only one HTML button element
2. Write and deploy a keyword-optimized meta title ('Retail Calculus — Cloud Software for Furniture & Big-Ticket Retailers') and a 158-char meta description — 30-minute fix
3. Update the copyright footer from 2016 to 2016-2026 and fix Twitter/Facebook links to actual company profiles — 15-minute fix
4. Install Google Analytics GA4 — paste one script tag into the head. Without this, no optimization decision has any data behind it
5. Submit free listings to G2, Capterra, and Software Advice — where furniture software buyers research vendors. Takes 2 hours, generates inbound intent traffic at zero cost

Medium-Term (1-3 Months)

1. Secure one named customer testimonial with a specific outcome metric (e.g., 'Vendis reduced our special-order configuration time from 20 minutes to 4') and replace the hidden Mitch Kapor quote on the homepage
2. Create a pricing page with tier framing (Starter: 1-3 stores / Growth: 4-10 stores / Enterprise: custom) — even if all tiers require a call, buyers need cost anchoring before they engage
3. Produce a 2-minute screen-capture demo video of Vendis configuring a furniture special order end-to-end — embed it on the homepage and contact page as a pre-CTA trust builder
4. Add Organization + LocalBusiness schema markup to the homepage — enables Google Knowledge Panel eligibility, rich SERP features, and AI citability for brand queries
5. Ed Rennemann publishes 3 LinkedIn articles on retail digital transformation from his Crate & Barrel experience — builds thought leadership and generates inbound connection requests from target buyers

Strategic (3-6 Months)

1. Rebuild the site as a multi-page architecture with dedicated landing pages for each product (Prime/PIM, Vendis/Selling Suite, Partum/Delivery, Optimus/Inventory, Sarcio/Work Orders), a pricing page, a blog, and legal pages — multiplies SEO surface area by 10x
2. Launch a content program targeting 6 foundational SEO articles: 'furniture retail software', 'PIM for furniture retailers', 'retail digital transformation', 'omnichannel inventory management retail', 'furniture sales associate tools', 'in-home delivery scheduling software'

3. Build a 'Why Retail Calculus vs. All-in-One ERP' comparison page explicitly naming STORIS and Celerant, leading with the bolt-on advantage, implementation cost savings, and no-disruption narrative — targets high-intent buyers actively comparing vendors

Competitive Landscape

	Retail Calculus	STORIS	Furniture Wizard	Celerant / Cumulus
Positioning	Retail Calculus	Dominant furniture ERP; 35-40% of inventory management; 100+ employees	PO & inventory management; 100+ employees	Online furniture platform; 100+ employees
Pricing	Retail Calculus	Enterprise; available on request	Available on request; SaaS \$100-\$250/month	\$100-\$250/month; publicly posted; clear upgrade path
Social Proof	Retail Calculus	Named customer community; 8 High Point reviews (4.1 stars)	8 High Point reviews (4.1 stars)	8 High Point reviews (4.1 stars); 10+ case studies; 10+ testimonials
Content	Retail Calculus	Active blog; thought leadership	Multi-page site; product pages; blog; system integrators	Multi-page site; product pages; blog; system integrators

Methodology

This audit evaluates six key dimensions of marketing effectiveness. Each category is scored 0-100 based on industry best practices and competitive benchmarks.

Category	Weight	What We Measure
Content & Messaging	25%	Copy quality, value proposition clarity, CTA effectiveness
Conversion Optimization	20%	Funnel design, forms, social proof, friction reduction
SEO & Discoverability	20%	On-page SEO, technical SEO, content structure
Competitive Positioning	15%	Market differentiation, pricing, alternatives strategy
Brand & Trust	10%	Design quality, trust signals, authority indicators
Growth & Strategy	10%	Pricing strategy, acquisition channels, retention

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